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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

ELECTION 2025



Aurora Mayor Richard Irvin speaks with supporters after conceding to challenger John Laesch during a watch party at his election headquarters Tuesday in Aurora. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

In suburbs, ‘a seismic shift’

GOP suffers losses in areas critical to rebuilding effort

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Two days before Tuesday’s local elections, the Illinois Republican Party sent out an email to supporters declaring it to be “a do or die moment for us.”

The email was just another in a series of fundraising solicitations. But it may have more accurately captured the importance of the election, which featured wide-ranging Democratic victories in the suburbs critical for rebuilding a state GOP already on the verge of irrelevance in Illinois politics and reflected voter angst over the early tumultuous months of Republican President Donald Trump’s second presidency.

“There was a broad rejection of what Donald Trump and the Republican Party



Mayoral challenger John Laesch makes a celebratory speech at Two Brothers Roundhouse during a watch party Tuesday in Aurora. “Tonight the candle of hope burns a little brighter,” Laesch said. **AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Most mayoral incumbents survive challenges

Despite voters dumping a few high-profile suburban mayors, most incumbents claimed victory Tuesday in a flurry of races that were hotly contested but generally saw low voter turnout. Returns show incumbents in Evanston, Elmhurst, Oak Park, Park Ridge, North Chicago and Tinley Park appeared to have held on to their seats. **Chicagoland, Page 5**

Turn to Elections, Page 5

Detained migrant allowed to donate kidney

ICE will temporarily release man with an ailing brother

By Laura Rodríguez Presa
Chicago Tribune

The attorney representing two Venezuelan siblings announced Wednesday that one of the brothers will be released from ICE custody under supervision in order

to donate his kidney to his ailing younger brother, an asylum-seeker in Cicero.

The attorney, Peter Meinecke, and The Resurrection Project, a nonprofit advocacy group representing the case, told the Tribune that José Gregorio González, 43, would likely be released this week from detention in Clay County Detention Center in Indiana, though details were still unclear. ICE could not be immediately reached for comment.

His brother, Alfredo Pacheco, 37, is facing terminal renal failure. Last month, the Tribune was the first to report that González had been arrested by Immigration and Customs Enforcement authorities and was awaiting deportation.

Pacheco is still in disbelief that his brother will return to their home in Cicero to undergo the organ transplant.

Turn to Kidney, Page 4

CHICAGOLAND

In Mexico, Pritzker touts strong trade relationship

Gov. JB Pritzker on Wednesday said his mission to Mexico this week was an opportunity to cast Illinois as “a stable and reliable trade partner” at a time of economic uncertainty as President Donald Trump imposes tariffs on goods.

Turn to Tariffs, Page 4

GEORGE FREEMAN 1927-2025

Trailblazing Chicago jazz guitarist enjoyed a late-career renaissance

By Hannah Edgar
Chicago Tribune

You could recognize George Freeman’s playing anywhere.

When tenor saxophonist Gene Ammons and his sextet appeared as guests on WTTW-Ch. 11 in 1970, most members of the band generally hewed to the backing progressions. Then there was Freeman, daringly traipsing around their harmonic fringes in hard-rocking, blazing solos.

That was typical for the ever-adventurous Freeman, who died in Chicago on April 1. He was 97 years old. His death was confirmed by his nephew, Mark Freeman.

While still in his teens, Freeman was

among the first musicians in Chicago, and one of the first jazz guitarists anywhere, to champion the bleeding-edge bebop of his idol, Charlie Parker. He eventually got to play with Parker, in now-lauded performances at the Pershing Ballroom in the early 1950s.

The list of jazz greats with whom Freeman collaborated is long. Besides Parker and Ammons, for whom he wrote the hit “The Black Cat,” he side-manned for Count Basie, Dexter Gordon, Lester Young, Sonny Stitt, Jimmy McGriff, Coleman Hawkins and Harrison Bankhead.

Freeman’s virtuosic presence on the bandstand long attracted critical and

Turn to Freeman, Page 4



Jazz guitarist George Freeman at his Chicago home in 2014. **ZBIGNIEW BZDAK/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

TODAY’S WEATHER



High 55 Low 41

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
177th year No. 93 © Chicago Tribune

